

Pro Rug Cleaning Service

Ten rugs a day at \$40 each — a dirty job almost nobody in your town offers.

What It Is

A specialized rug-cleaning service using a rug-washing machine/centrifuge setup to deep-clean area rugs, runners, and oriental rugs. People hate doing this themselves and most carpet cleaners don't do proper rug submersion washing. You pick up dirty rugs, deep-clean and dry them, and return them looking new — and the satisfying "before/after" makes irresistible content.

How It Makes Money

Per-rug service fees, paid by homeowners, pet owners, Airbnb hosts, and interior designers. Average ticket is per-square-foot or flat per-rug pricing, with add-ons for pet-odor treatment, stain protection, fringe cleaning, and pickup/delivery. Recurring revenue from property managers and Airbnb cleaners who need rugs refreshed between turnovers.

Startup Costs

- Rug cleaning equipment: pressure washer or rug-wash machine + water claw extractor; entry setup \$800–\$2,500 (a centrifuge wringer is the upgrade at \$3k–\$8k)
- Rug cleaning solutions, deodorizers, stain protector: \$150–\$300
- Drying setup: fans / drying rack / dedicated garage space: \$200–\$500
- Van or trailer for pickup (can start with your own vehicle): \$0–\$2,000
- LLC, insurance, GoHighLevel CRM + booking site: \$300–\$600
- Branding, magnets, business cards: \$100–\$200
- **Total to start: \$1,500–\$4,000 lean; \$6k+ with a centrifuge**

The Numbers

- Cost per rug: solution + water + power ~\$3–\$6, plus your labor (~45 min)
- Sell price: **\$40 per rug** (or \$2–\$4/sq ft; large rugs \$80–\$150)
- Profit per rug: **~\$34–\$37**
- Realistic monthly: the reel's math — 10 rugs/day × \$40 × 25 days = **\$10,000 revenue**, ~\$8,500+ profit at scale. Starting part-time at 3–4 rugs/day still nets \$3k–\$4k/month.

How To Start

1. Buy a starter rug-wash setup (pressure washer, water claw extractor, drying fans) and practice on your own rugs.
2. Dial in a repeatable process: dust, wash, rinse, extract, dry, groom.
3. Film dramatic before/after and dirty-water reveal videos — this is the entire marketing engine.
4. Set flat pricing (\$40 standard, tiers for size/oriental/pet) and a booking page in GoHighLevel.
5. Offer free pickup and delivery within your service area to beat competitors.
6. Hand flyers/door-hangers to neighborhoods with pets and to local Airbnb hosts.
7. Collect a review + a video testimonial from every job to compound social proof.

Where To Get Customers

- TikTok/Instagram/YouTube Shorts of satisfying before/after cleans (drives most leads)
- Google Business Profile + local SEO for "rug cleaning near me"
- Facebook local and neighborhood (Nextdoor) groups
- Partnerships with carpet cleaners (they refer rug jobs they can't do)
- Airbnb hosts, property managers, and interior designers for recurring work

Pro Tips

- The dirty-water and before/after shots ARE the ad — film every rug; one viral clean can book you out for weeks.
- Partner with regular carpet-cleaning companies rather than competing — most don't do submersion rug washing and will happily refer those jobs for a kickback.
- Add a "pet odor + protectant" upsell at \$20–\$40; it costs you almost nothing and pet owners (your best market) always say yes.